MINOAN LINEAR A

VOLUME I

HURRIANS AND HURRIAN IN MINOAN CRETE

PART 1: TEXT

To Jan M. Veldhuizen-van Soesbergen

and in remembrance of

Anna M. van Soesbergen-Jurriaans

and Petrus J. van Soesbergen

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MINOAN LINEAR A - VOLUME I: HURRIANS AND HURRIAN IN MINOAN CRETE PART 1: TEXT

by

Peter George van Soesbergen

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THE MAIN LINEAR A PHONETIC SIGNS (ARRANGED ACCORDING TO THE LINEAR B SYLLABARY)

LINEAR A IDEOGRAMS

After J. Raison - M. Pope, *Index transnuméré du Lineaire A* (BCILL 11), Louvain 1977, 54: Signes du deuxième groupe.

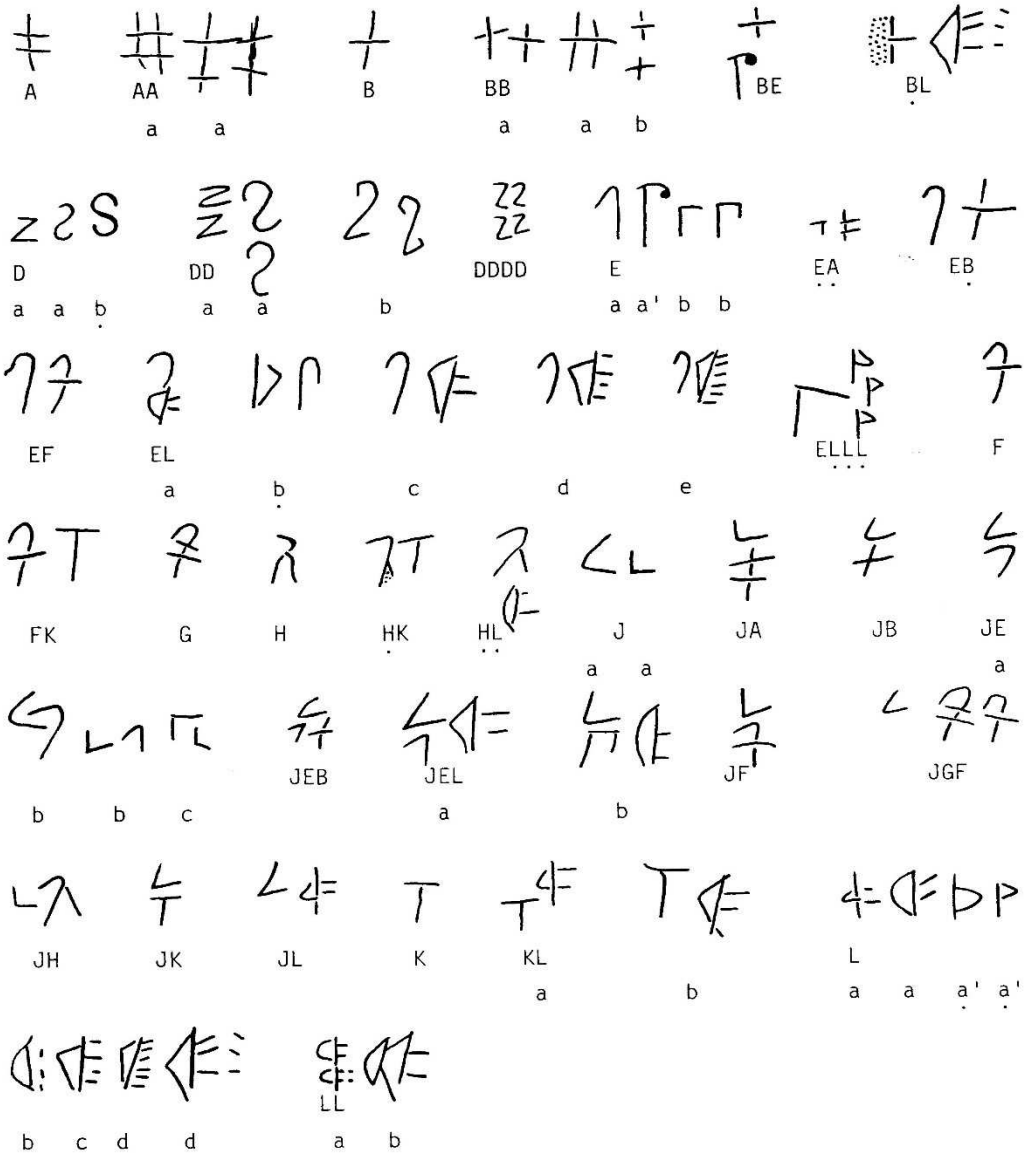
J. Raison - M. Pope (*Index transnuméré du Lineaire A*, BCILL 11, Louvain 1977, 48-53) provide sub 'Signes du premier groupe' the whole range of primarily syllabic signs and their variants. Some of these signs (e.g. *8*, *35*, *42*, *82a*, *82b*, *85*, *87*) are probably ideograms and some might be both syllabogram and ideogram, e.g. *27*, *29*, *48b*, *60*, *66*, *99*, *103*. Sign *29* is usually the syllabic sign *ka*, but in solitary position it probably indicates the ideogram ROTA 'wheel', and in combination with the ideogram VIR it may well indicate a round shield (PARMA), so that the whole combination could represent a VIR PARMATUS, 'man armed with a round shield'.

Sub 'Signes du troisième groupe' J. Raison - M. Pope (*ibidem*, 55-57) provide the 'ligature signs'. Some of these consist of ideograms with additions of syllabograms indicating varieties of the commodities in question, e.g. *501*, *503*, *512*, *513*, *515*, *516*, *517*, *518*, *521*, *522*, *524*, *525*, *528*, etc.

Others consist of ideograms with additions of signs indicating dry measures: sign *502*, for instance, shows the GRA(num) ideogram with the addition of double Linear A signs 'L', which probably is equivalent to Linear B sign V, possibly the classical *χοῖνιξ*, whereas sign *504* shows the GRA(num) ideogram with the addition of a single Linear A sign 'L'. Sign *511* shows the GRA(num) ideogram with the addition of a single Linear A sign 'L' and a single Linear A sign 'K', which probably is equivalent to Linear B sign T. From Linear B we know that the smallest dry and liquid measures are the signs Z (probably the *κοτύλη*) and V (the *χοῖνιξ*). In Linear B the dry measures have the following values: Z x 4 = V; V x 6 = T; T x 10 = GRA. According to J. Chadwick the wheat ideogram may indicate the highest unit of the dry measures, representing the maximum load an average man could carry. He also considers the wine ideogram the highest unit of the liquid measures, again representing the maximum load an average man could carry (cf. J. Chadwick, *Reading the past, Linear B and related scripts*, British Museum Publications, London 1987, 32). There is no reason to assume that the values of the Linear A measures differed very much from those in Linear B.

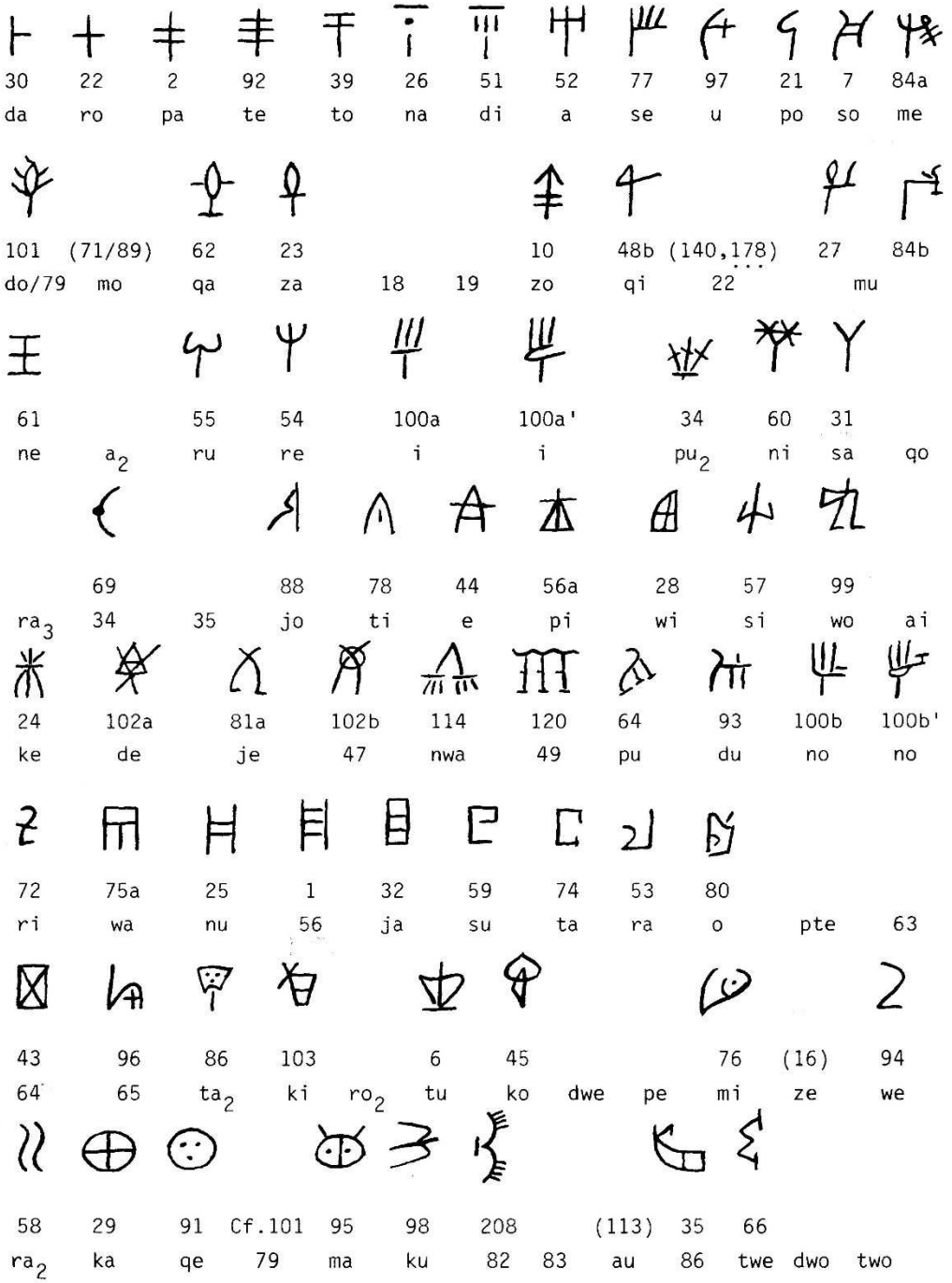
Other 'ligature signs' may be a combination of two ideograms. Sign *536* is probably a combination of sign *35* (CAPSUS of a chariot) and *87* (framework of a chariot). Sign *672* may be sign *87* combined with the sign of another part of the chariot.

LINEAR A SIGNS INDICATING FRACTIONS, WEIGHTS, MEASURES



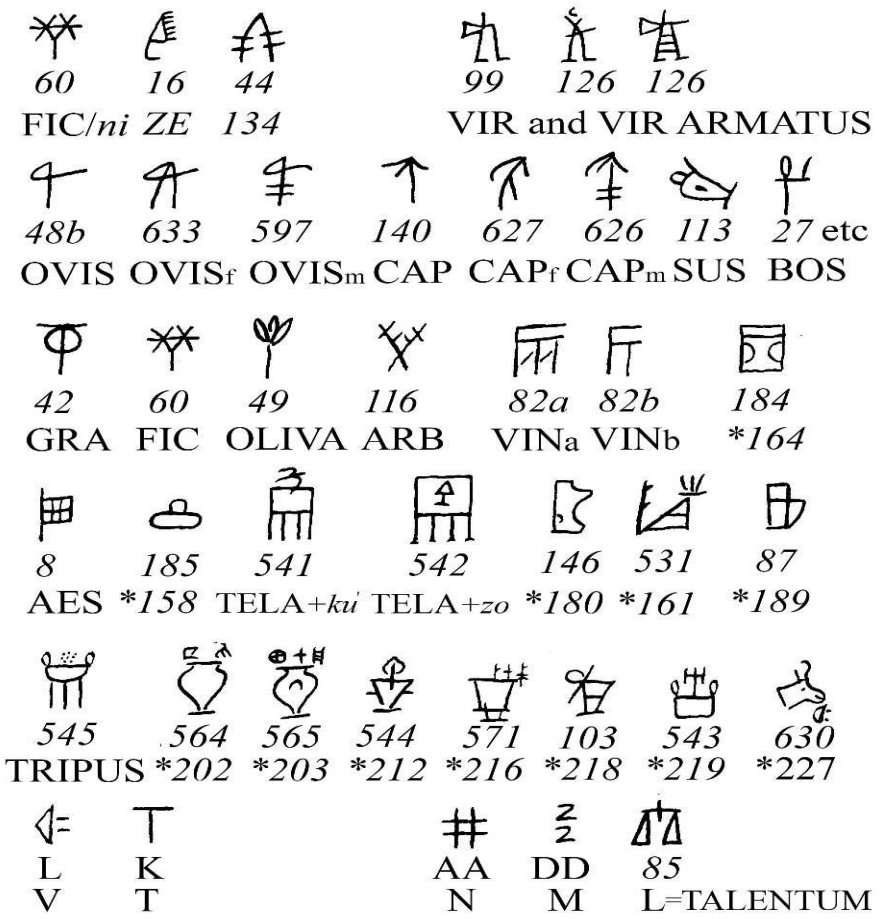
After J. Raison - M. Pope, *Index transnuméré du Lineaire A* (BCILL 11), Louvain 1977, 58: Signes du quatrième groupe.

LINEAR A SYLLABIC SIGNS RESEMBLING LINEAR B SIGNS (ACCORDING TO J. RAISON - M. POPE)



After J. Raison - M. Pope, *Index transnuméré du Lineaire A* (BCILL 11), Louvain 1977, 60: Ressemblances A – B.

LINEAR A IDEOGRAMS, IDEOGRAMS WITH ADDED VALUES, SIGNS FOR MEASURES AND WEIGHTS RESEMBLING LINEAR B SIGNS



This chart is partly after J. Raison - M. Pope, *Index transnuméré du Lineaire A* (BCILL 11), Louvain 1977, 61: Ressemblances A – B. I have, however, rearranged the order in such a way that the ideograms of domestic animals, those of agricultural commodities, those of other commodities, those of various vases, and the signs for measures and weights are put together in their own groups. In my view sign *126* is not the ideogram MUL(ier) 'woman', but VIR ARMATUS 'armed man'. Especially the second example of sign *126* shows close resemblance to both Linear B sign **100* = VIR and Linear B signs **162* and **163* = LORICA 'a leather cuirass or corselet'. Linear A sign *116* ARB(OR) may be the ideogram of AURUM (B **141*).